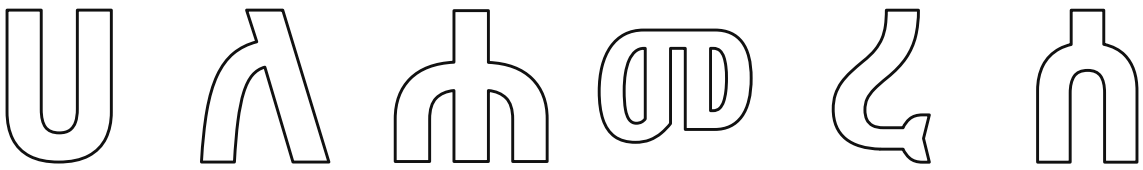
ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 57

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Tigrinya Alphabet

ፊደል ትግርኛ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 32 Tigrinya Letters with English Phonetics



Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Tigrinya Alphabet — ፊደል ትግርኛ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 57

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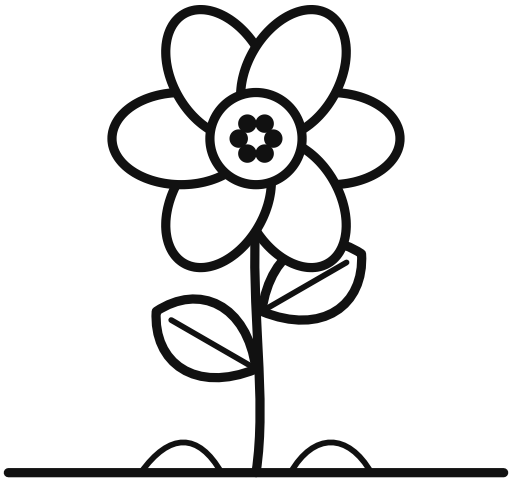
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Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

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Map data: Natural Earth (public domain).

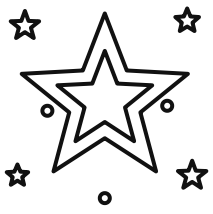
A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



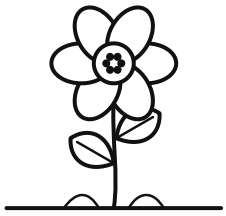
This book belongs to

እዚ መጽሓፍ ናተይ እዩ

I started learning Tigrinya on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 57 is Tigrinya. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- Vowels: **e** as in "the" · **u** as in "rule" · **i** as in "ski" · **a** as in "father" · **é** as in "café" · **o** as in "go". **(i)** is a very quick 'i', often silent.
- An **apostrophe after a consonant** (*q, t', ch', p', ts'*) marks a **popped** sound: hold your breath, then let it burst out.
- **ḥ** is the Arabic ح; ʿ is the Arabic ع; **kh** and **qh** are soft, scratchy sounds like the Arabic خ.
- **ny** as in "canyon"; **zh** like the 's' in "measure". Hyphens split the syllables; say them all evenly.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Tigrinya name** written in Tigrinya (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *The … family · 7 sounds* shows the letter's **whole family**: the base letter and its six vowel forms, each with its sound. The shaded form is the one used in the word on that page.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow the Tigrinya of Asmara.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Tigrinya! ትግርኛ

tig-ri-nya — the Tigrinya word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **10 million people** speak Tigrinya.[3]

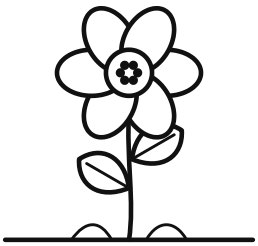
Where?
In **Eritrea** and in the **Tigray** region of northern **Ethiopia**, in East Africa, and in Tigrinya-speaking families around the world.

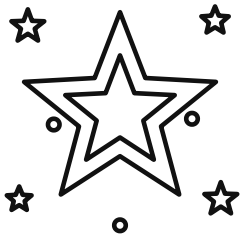
How is it written?
In the **fidel** (ፊደል), from **left to right**, like Amharic. Each letter is a whole syllable, like *ba* or *mo*.

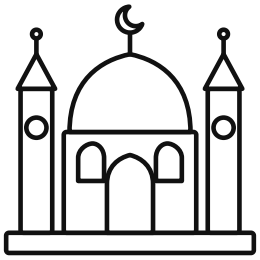
How many letters?
32 letter families, each with **7 forms**: more than 200 letters, all made from a few simple shapes!

Sounds you know!
Tigrinya has the throat sounds ሐ and ዐ: they are the Arabic ح and ع that Muslim children read in the Qur'an.

Did you know?
The first Muslims to leave Makkah for safety travelled to **al-Ḥabasha** (Abyssinia), where the just king, **an-Najāshī**, welcomed and protected them.







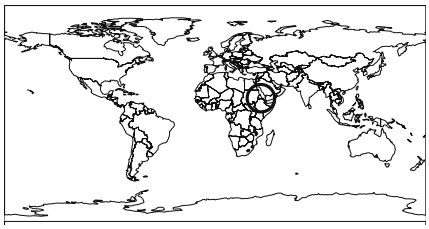
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Tigrinya Alphabet ፊደል

32 letter families — ፊደል

ሀ *he*	ለ *le*	ሐ *ḥe*	መ *me*	ረ *re*	ሰ *se*	ሸ *she*
ቀ *qe*	ቐ *qhe*	በ *be*	ቨ *ve*	ተ *te*	ቸ *che*	ነ *ne*
ኘ *nye*	አ *e*	ከ *ke*	ኸ *khe*	ወ *we*	ዐ *ʿe*	ዘ *ze*
ዠ *zhe*	የ *ye*	ደ *de*	ጀ *je*	ገ *ge*	ጠ *t'e*	ጨ *ch'e*
ጰ *p'e*	ጸ *ts'e*	ፈ *fe*	ፐ *pe*			

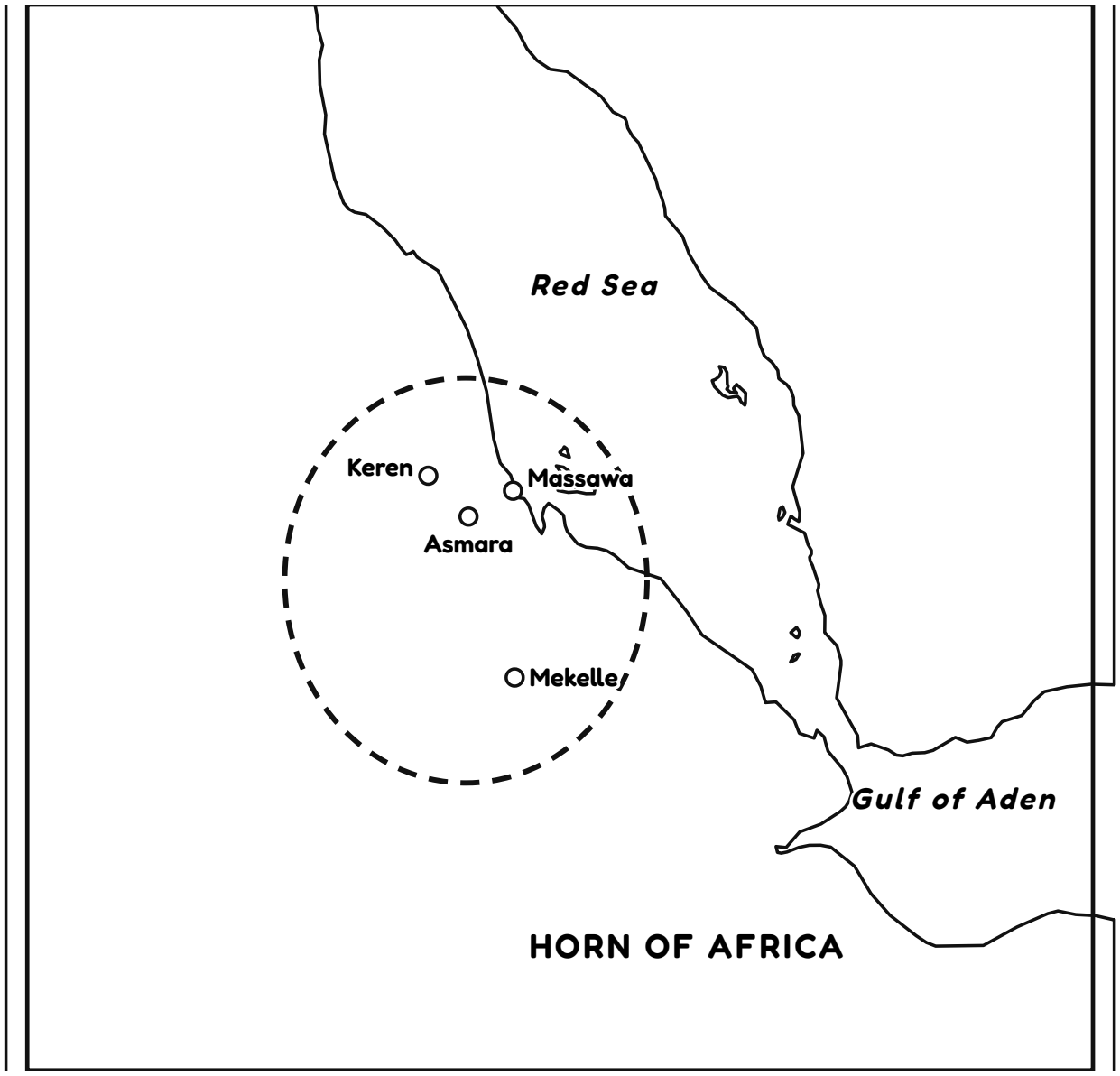
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the Horn of Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Tigrinya spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the seas **blue**. **Find it:** the dashed line shows where Tigrinya is spoken: the highlands of Eritrea, around Asmara and Keren, and the Tigray region of northern Ethiopia, around Mekelle.

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

The Fidel ፊደል

fi-del — “the letters”

Tigrinya is written with the **fidel** (ፊደል). Every letter stands for a whole **syllable**: a consonant *and* a vowel together. This book teaches **32 letter families**.

One family, seven sounds

Each family starts with its **base letter** (the 1st form). Small changes to its shape give six more forms, one for each vowel. Read the grid across: *le*, *lu*, *li*, *la*, *lé*, *l(i)*, *lo*.

1st ግዕዝ	2nd ካዕብ	3rd ሣልስ	4th ራብዕ	5th ኃምስ	6th ሳድስ	7th ሳብዕ
-e	**-u**	**-i**	**-a**	**-é**	**-(i)**	**-o**
ለ *le*	ሉ *lu*	ሊ *li*	ላ *la*	ሌ *lé*	ል *l(i)*	ሎ *lo*
መ *me*	ሙ *mu*	ሚ *mi*	ማ *ma*	ሜ *mé*	ም *m(i)*	ሞ *mo*
በ *be*	ቡ *bu*	ቢ *bi*	ባ *ba*	ቤ *bé*	ብ *b(i)*	ቦ *bo*
ሐ *ḥe*	ሑ *ḥu*	ሒ *ḥi*	ሓ *ḥa*	ሔ *ḥé*	ሕ *ḥ(i)*	ሖ *ḥo*

The forms are called ግዕዝ ካዕብ ሣልስ ራብዕ ኃምስ ሳድስ ሳብዕ (*ge'ez*, *ka'ib*, *salis*, *rabi'*, *hamis*, *sadis*, *sabi'*): 1st to 7th.

Spot the vowel marks

2nd: a little stroke on the right (ሉ) · 3rd: a foot on the right leg (ሊ) · 4th: a leg that grows or bends (ላ) · 5th: a little ring (ሌ) · 6th: a bent or broken leg (ል) · 7th: a ring or a shorter leg (ሎ).

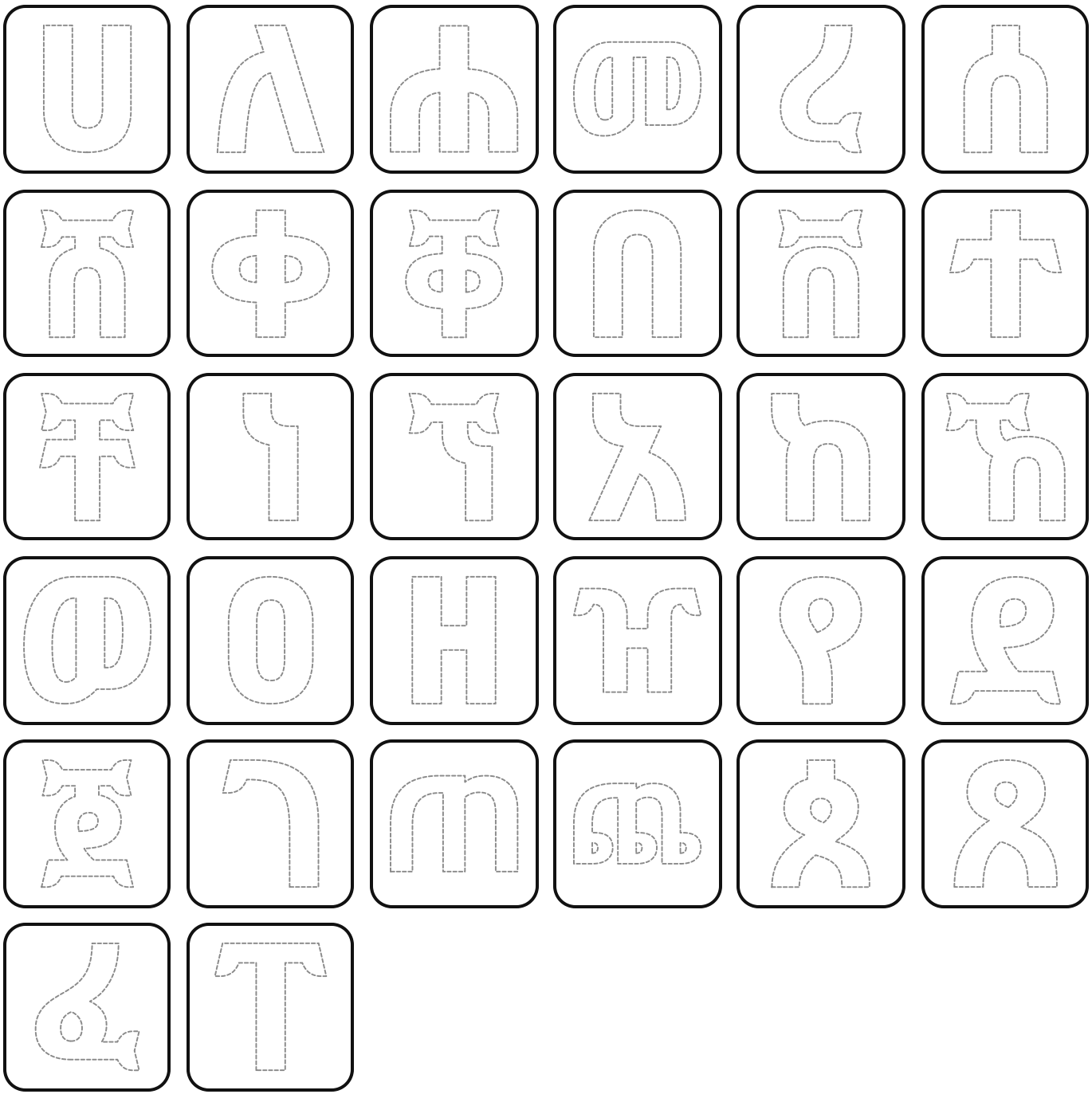
Tigrinya’s own letters

ቐ and ኸ are soft, scratchy forms of ቀ and ከ that come after a vowel. Tigrinya also keeps ሀ and ሐ, and ኣ and ዐ, as different sounds. On every letter page the **shaded** form in the family box is the one used in the word.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the base letters ፊደል

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ሀ

NAME · ስም

ሀ

he

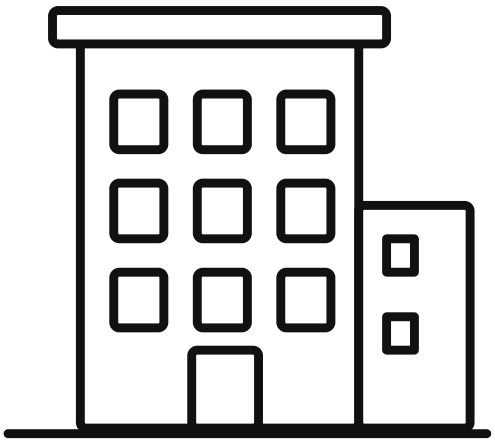
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

THE ሀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሀ	ሁ	ሂ	ሃ	ሄ	ህ	ሆ
he 1st	*hu* 2nd	*hi* 3rd	*ha* 4th	*hé* 5th	*h(i)* 6th	*ho* 7th

ህ *hi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ህንጻ.



ሀ IS FOR

ህንጻ

hin-ts'a

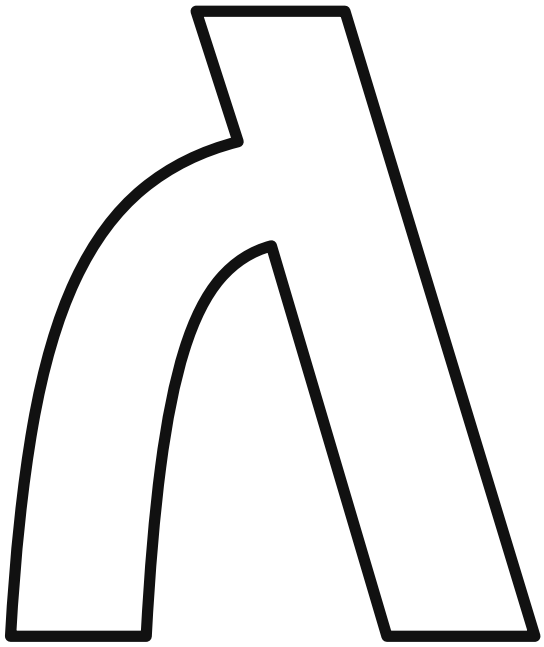
building

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ሀ ሀ ሀ ሀ

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NAME · ስም

ለ

le

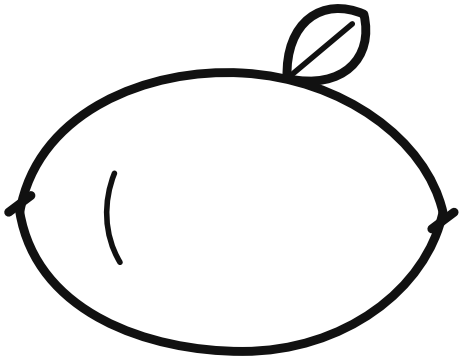
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

THE ለ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ለ	ሉ	ሊ	ላ	ሌ	ል	ሎ
le 1st	*lu* 2nd	*li* 3rd	*la* 4th	*lé* 5th	*l(i)* 6th	*lo* 7th

ሎ *lo*, the **7th** sound of this family, starts the word ሎሚ.



ለ IS FOR

ሎሚ

lo-mi

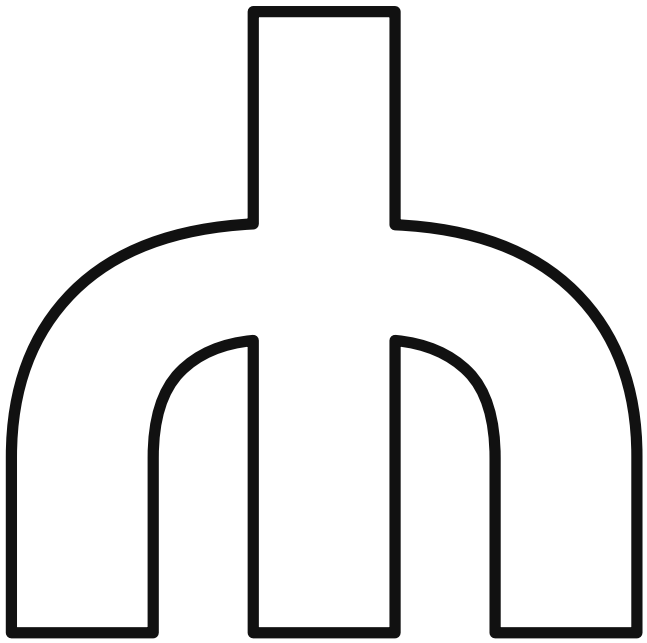
lemon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ለ ለ ለ ለ

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NAME · ስም

ሐ

ḥe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

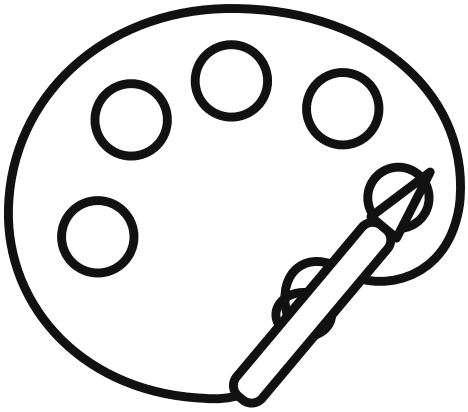
a strong, breathy ‘h’ from deep in the throat, like the Arabic letter ح

THE ሐ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሐ	ሑ	ሒ	ሓ	ሔ	ሕ	ሖ
ḥe 1st	*ḥu* 2nd	*ḥi* 3rd	*ḥa* 4th	*ḥé* 5th	*ḥ(i)* 6th	*ḥo* 7th

ሕ *ḥi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ሕብሪ.

Muslim children know this sound from the Qur’an: it is the Arabic ح.



ሐ IS FOR

ሕብሪ

ḥib-ri

colour

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ሐ ሐ ሐ ሐ

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መ

NAME · ስም

መ

me

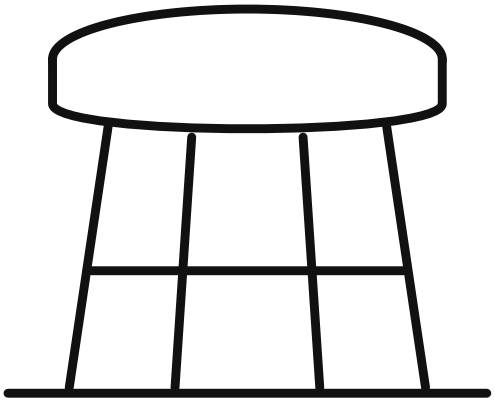
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

THE መ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

መ	መ	ሚ	ማ	ሜ	ም	ሞ
me 1st	*mu* 2nd	*mi* 3rd	*ma* 4th	*mé* 5th	*m(i)* 6th	*mo* 7th

መ *me*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word መንበር.



መ IS FOR

መንበር

men-ber

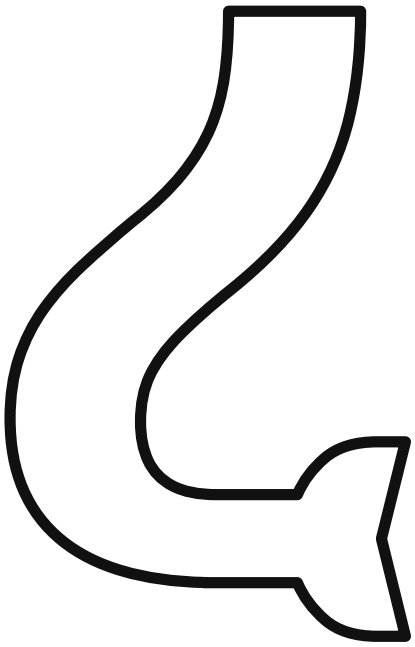
chair, stool

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

መ መ መ መ

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NAME · ስም

ረ

re

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a quick tapped ‘r’, as in Spanish “pero”

THE ረ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ረ	ሩ	ሪ	ራ	ሬ	ር	ሮ
re 1st	*ru* 2nd	*ri* 3rd	*ra* 4th	*ré* 5th	*r(i)* 6th	*ro* 7th

ሩ *ru*, the **2nd** sound of this family, starts the word ሩዝ.



ረ IS FOR

ሩዝ

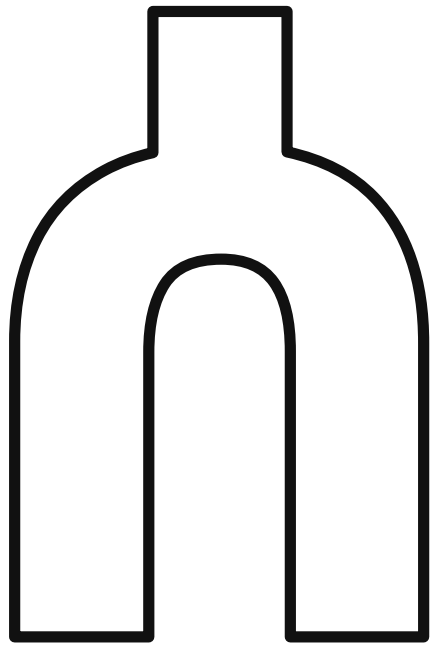
ruz

rice

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

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NAME · ስም

ሰ

se

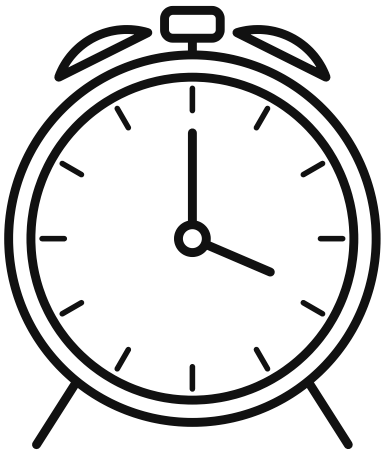
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

THE ሰ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሰ	ሱ	ሲ	ሳ	ሴ	ስ	ሶ
se 1st	*su* 2nd	*si* 3rd	*sa* 4th	*sé* 5th	*s(i)* 6th	*so* 7th

ሰ *se*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ሰዓት.



ሰ IS FOR

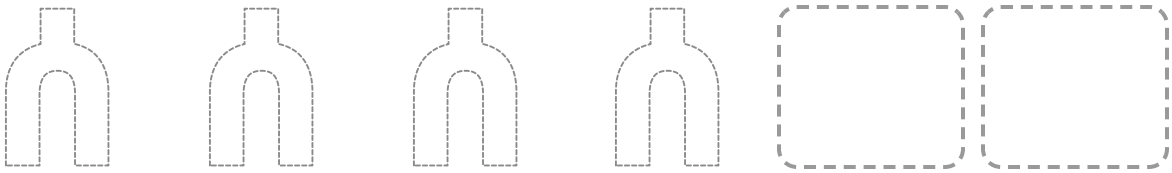
ሰዓት

se-ʿat

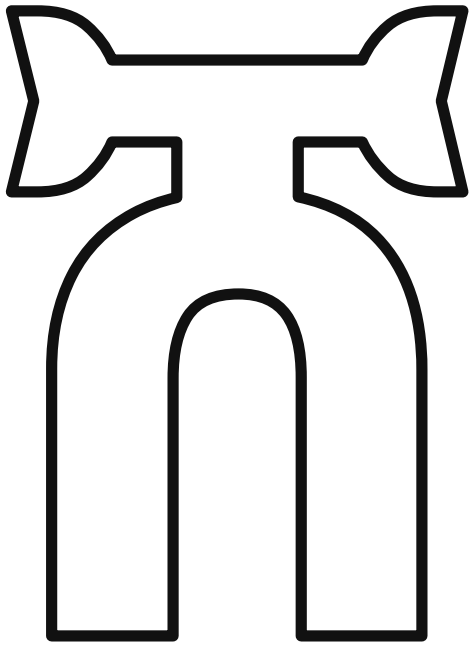
clock

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ



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NAME · ስም

ሸ

she

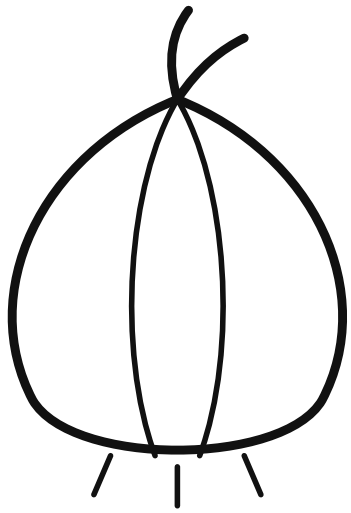
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘sh’ as in “ship”

THE ሸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ሸ	ሹ	ሺ	ሻ	ሼ	ሽ	ሾ
she 1st	*shu* 2nd	*shi* 3rd	*sha* 4th	*shé* 5th	*sh(i)* 6th	*sho* 7th

ሽ *shi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ሽጉርቲ.



ሸ IS FOR

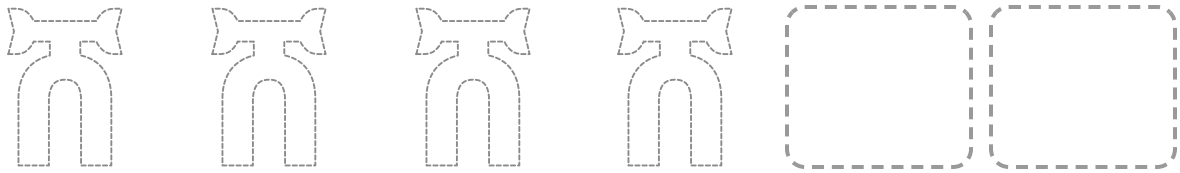
ሽጉርቲ

shi-gur-ti

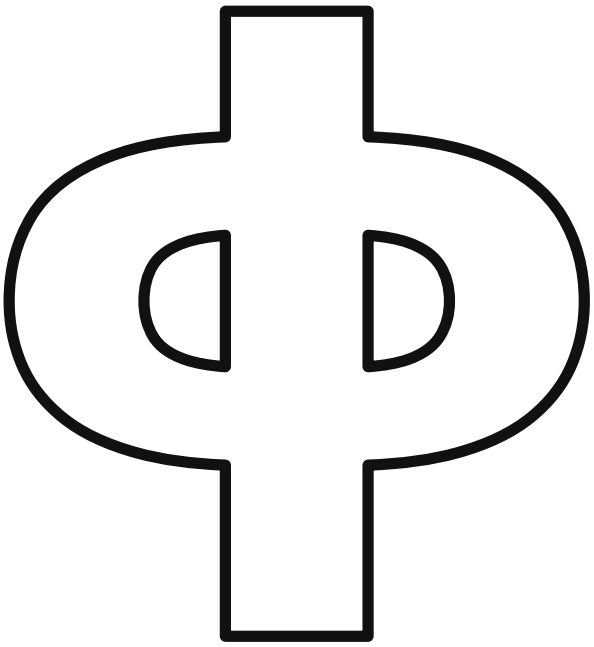
onion

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ



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NAME · ስም

ቀ

qe

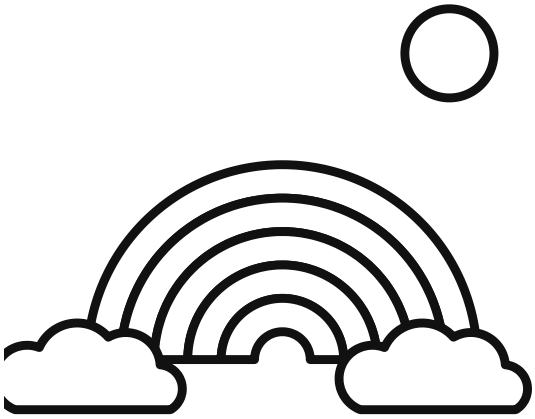
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘q’ — a ‘k’ said far back in the throat (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ቀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ቀ	ቁ	ቂ	ቃ	ቄ	ቅ	ቆ
qe 1st	*qu* 2nd	*qi* 3rd	*qa* 4th	*qé* 5th	*q(i)* 6th	*qo* 7th

ቀ *qe*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ቀስቲ ደበና.



ቀ IS FOR

ቀስቲ ደበና

qes-ti de-be-na

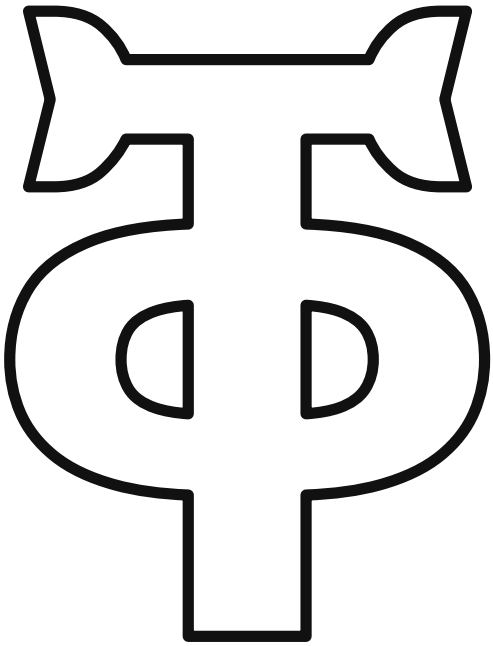
rainbow

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ቀ ቀ ቀ ቀ

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NAME · ስም

ቐ

qhe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

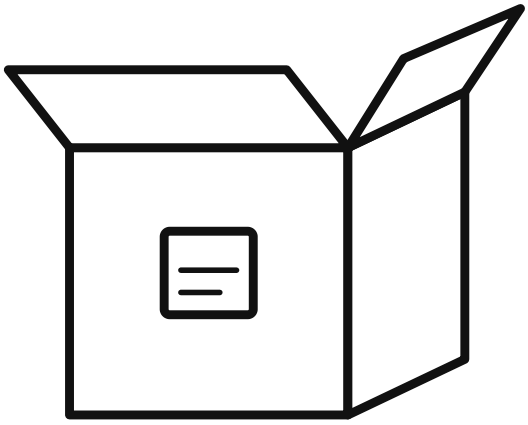
a soft, scratchy ‘kh’ from the back of the throat: ቀ said softly after a vowel

THE ቐ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ቐ	ቑ	ቒ	ቓ	ቔ	ቕ	ቖ
qhe 1st	*qhu* 2nd	*qhi* 3rd	*qha* 4th	*qhé* 5th	*qh(i)* 6th	*qho* 7th

ቕ *qhi*, the **6th** sound of this family, is found inside the word ሳንዱቕ.

ቐ never starts a word. Find ቕ at the end of ሳንዱቕ!



ቐ IS FOR

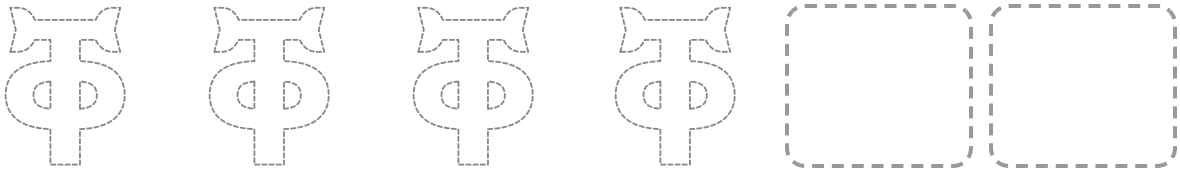
ሳንዱቕ

san-duqh

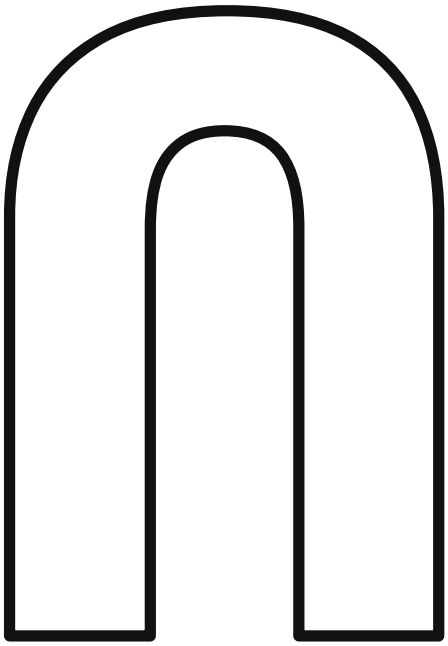
box

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ



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NAME · ስም

በ

be

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

THE በ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

በ	ቡ	ቢ	ባ	ቤ	ብ	ቦ
be 1st	*bu* 2nd	*bi* 3rd	*ba* 4th	*bé* 5th	*b(i)* 6th	*bo* 7th

ባ *ba*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ባኒ.



በ IS FOR

ባኒ

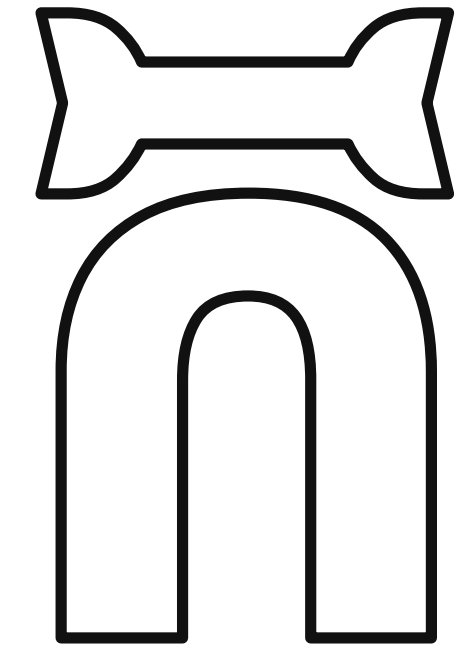
ba-ni

bread

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

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NAME · ስም

ቨ

ve

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

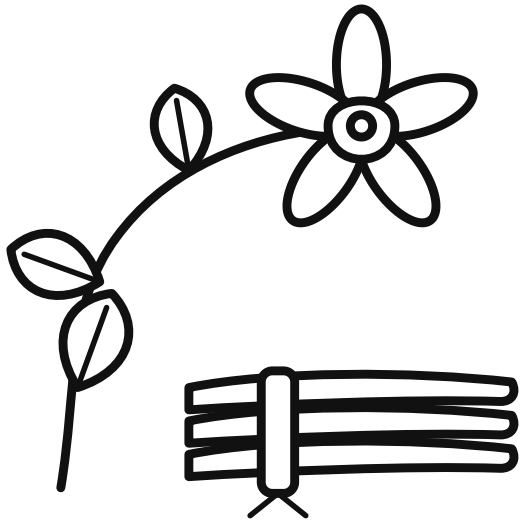
‘v’ as in “van”

THE ቨ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ቨ	ቩ	ቪ	ቫ	ቬ	ቭ	ቮ
ve 1st	*vu* 2nd	*vi* 3rd	*va* 4th	*vé* 5th	*v(i)* 6th	*vo* 7th

ቫ *va*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ቫኒላ.

ቨ is a newer letter, used only in words borrowed from other languages.



ቨ IS FOR

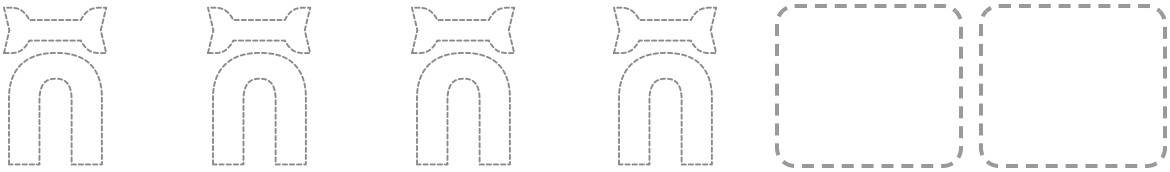
ቫኒላ

va-ni-la

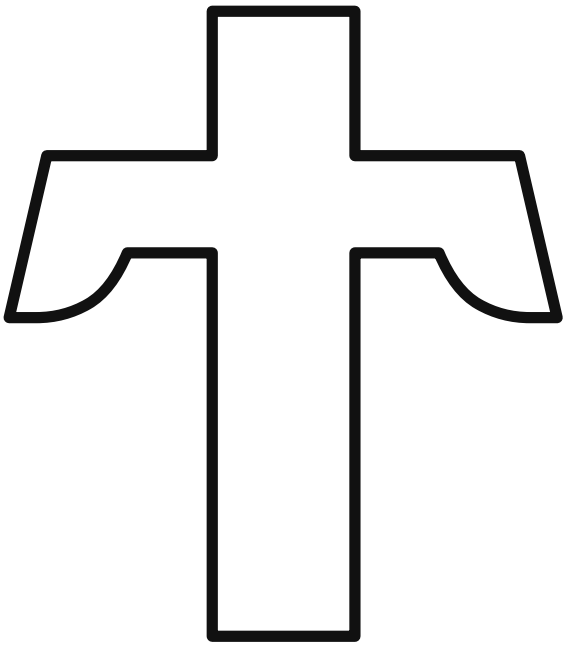
vanilla (a climbing plant with sweet pods)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ



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NAME · ስም

ተ

te

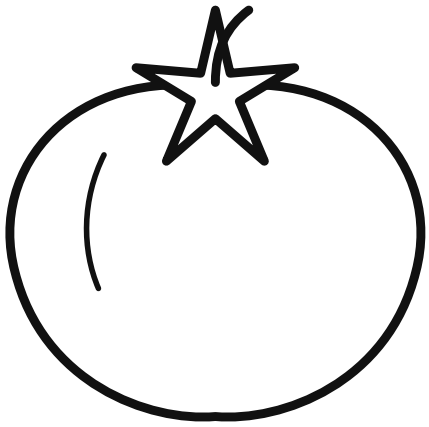
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘t’ as in “top”

THE ተ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ተ	ቱ	ቲ	ታ	ቴ	ት	ቶ
te 1st	*tu* 2nd	*ti* 3rd	*ta* 4th	*té* 5th	*t(i)* 6th	*to* 7th

ቲ *ti*, the **3rd** sound of this family, starts the word ቲማቲም.



ተ IS FOR

ቲማቲም

ti-ma-tim

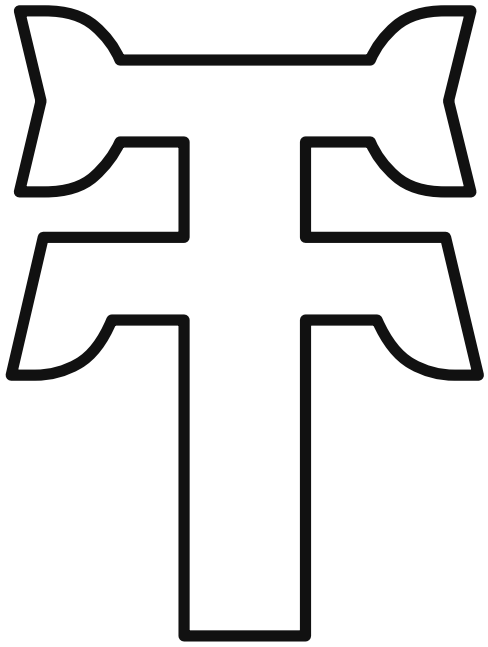
tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ተ ተ ተ ተ

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NAME · ስም

ቸ

che

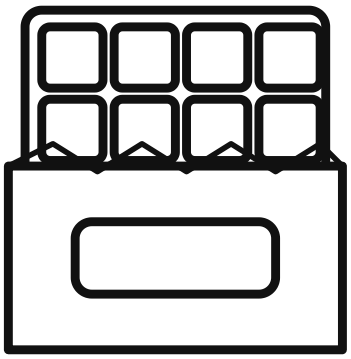
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

THE ቸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ቸ	ቹ	ቺ	ቻ	ቼ	ች	ቾ
che 1st	*chu* 2nd	*chi* 3rd	*cha* 4th	*ché* 5th	*ch(i)* 6th	*cho* 7th

ቸ *che*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ቸኮላታ.



ቸ IS FOR

ቸኮላታ

che-ko-la-ta

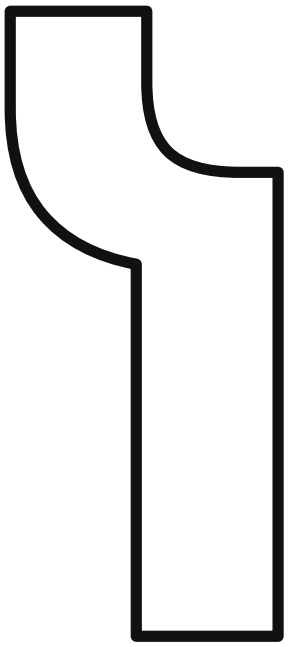
chocolate

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ቸ ቸ ቸ ቸ

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NAME · ስም

ነ

ne

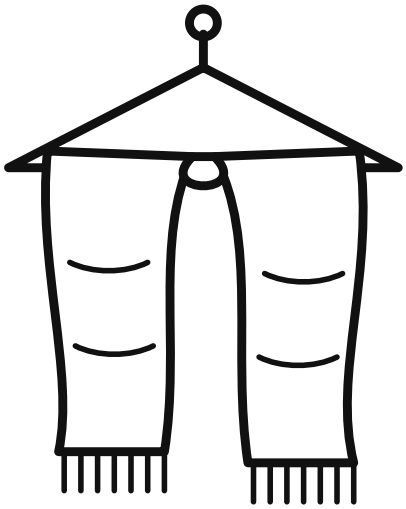
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

THE ነ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ነ	ኑ	ኒ	ና	ኔ	ን	ኖ
ne 1st	*nu* 2nd	*ni* 3rd	*na* 4th	*né* 5th	*n(i)* 6th	*no* 7th

ነ *ne*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ነጸላ.



ነ IS FOR

ነጸላ

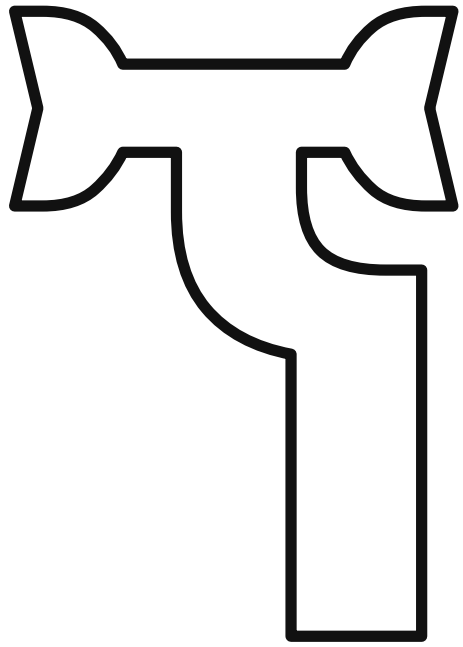
ne-ts'e-la

netsela, a light cotton shawl

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

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NAME · ስም

ኘ

nye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ny’ as in “canyon”

THE ኘ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ኘ	ኙ	ኚ	ኛ	ኜ	ኝ	ኞ
nye 1st	*nyu* 2nd	*nyi* 3rd	*nya* 4th	*nyé* 5th	*ny(i)* 6th	*nyo* 7th

ኛ *nya*, the **4th** sound of this family, is found inside the word ትግርኛ.

ኘ hardly ever starts a word. Find ኛ at the end of ትግርኛ!



ኘ IS FOR

ትግርኛ

tig-ri-nya

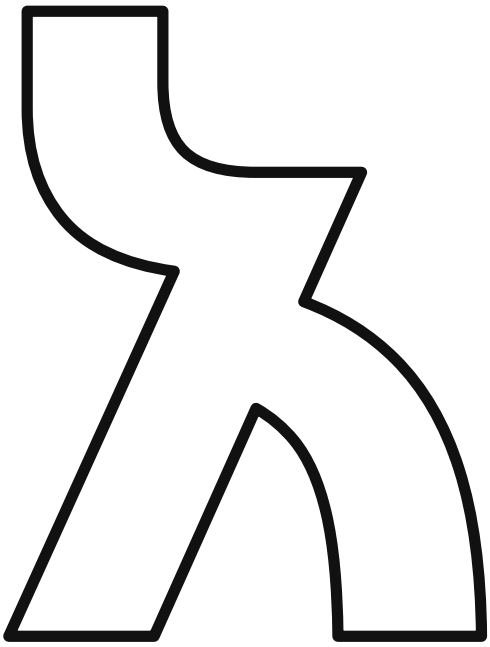
Tigrinya — the language of this book!

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ኘ ኘ ኘ ኘ

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NAME · ስም

እ

e

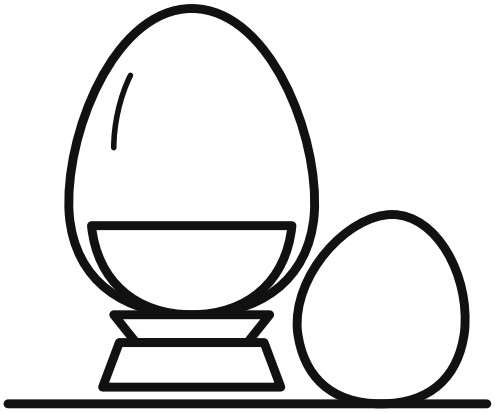
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

the vowels on their own: **እ** says ‘e’ as in “the”, and its 4th form **ኣ** says ‘a’

THE እ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

እ	ኡ	ኢ	ኣ	ኤ	እ	ኦ
e 1st	*u* 2nd	*i* 3rd	*a* 4th	*é* 5th	*i* 6th	*o* 7th

እ *i*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word እንቋቕሖ.



እ IS FOR

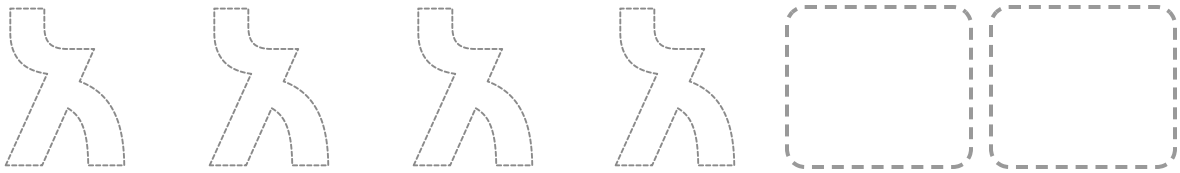
እንቋቕሖ

in-qwaqh-ḥo

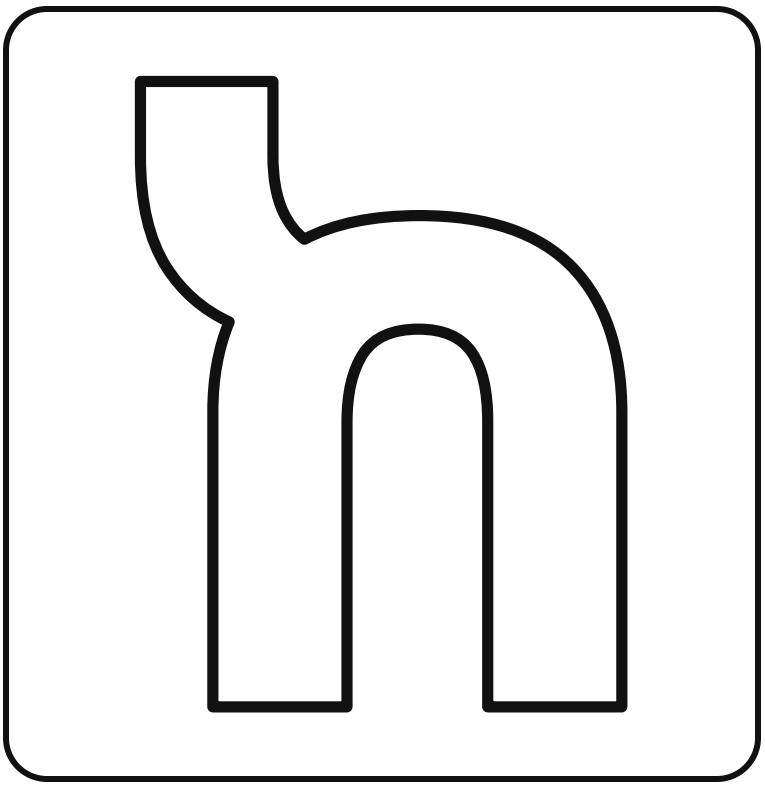
egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ



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NAME · ስም

ከ

ke

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

THE ከ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ከ	ኩ	ኪ	ካ	ኬ	ክ	ኮ
ke 1st	*ku* 2nd	*ki* 3rd	*ka* 4th	*ké* 5th	*k(i)* 6th	*ko* 7th

ኩ *ku*, the **2nd** sound of this family, starts the word ኩባያ.



ከ IS FOR

ኩባያ

ku-ba-ya

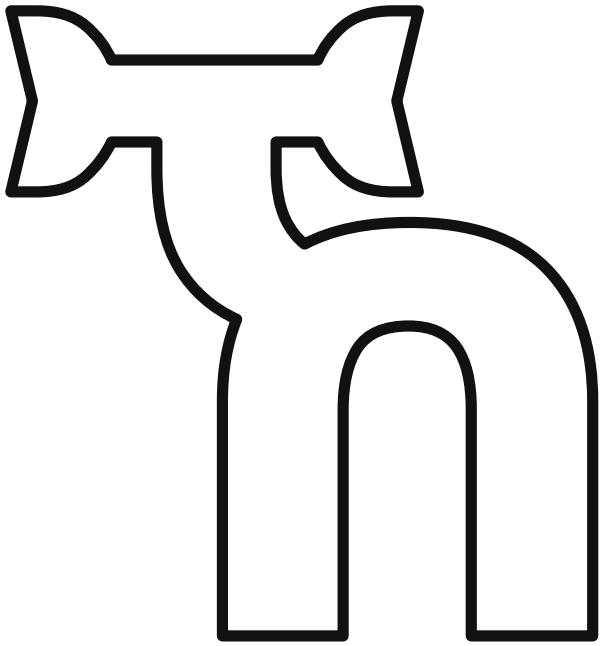
cup

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ከ ከ ከ ከ

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NAME · ስም

ኸ

khe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

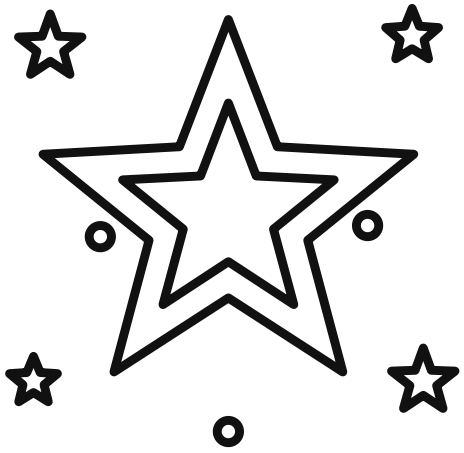
a soft, scratchy ‘kh’: ኸ said softly after a vowel

THE ኸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ኸ	ኹ	ኺ	ኻ	ኼ	ኽ	ኾ
khe 1st	*khu* 2nd	*khi* 3rd	*kha* 4th	*khé* 5th	*kh(i)* 6th	*kho* 7th

ኾ *kho*, the **7th** sound of this family, is found inside the word ኮኾብ.

ኸ hardly ever starts a word. Find ኸ in the middle of ኮኾብ!



ኸ IS FOR

ኮኾብ

ko-khob

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ኸ ኸ ኸ ኸ

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ወ

NAME · ስም

ወ

we

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘w’ as in “water”

THE ወ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ወ	ዉ	ዊ	ዋ	ዌ	ው	ዎ
we 1st	*wu* 2nd	*wi* 3rd	*wa* 4th	*wé* 5th	*w(i)* 6th	*wo* 7th

ወ *we*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ወርሒ.



ወ IS FOR

ወርሒ

wer-ḥi

moon; month

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ወ ወ ወ ወ

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ዐ

NAME · ስም

ዐ

ʿe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

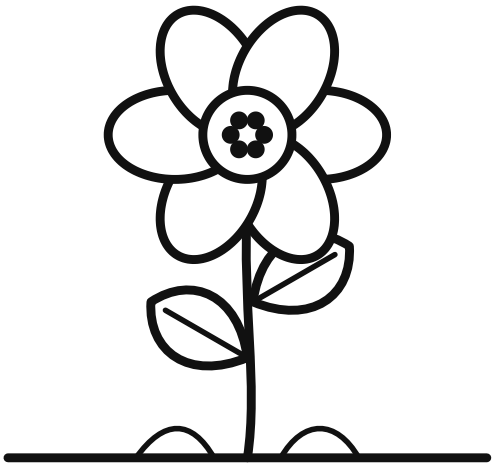
a squeezed sound from deep in the throat, like the Arabic letter ع

THE ዐ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ዐ	ዑ	ዒ	ዓ	ዔ	ዕ	ዖ
ʿe	ʿu	ʿi	ʿa	ʿé	ʿ(i)	ʿo
1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th

ዕ *ʿi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ዕምባባ.

Muslim children know this sound from the Qur'an: it is the Arabic ع.



ዐ IS FOR

ዕምባባ

ʿim-ba-ba

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ዐ ዐ ዐ ዐ

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ዘ

NAME · ስም

ዘ

ze

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

THE ዘ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ዘ	ዙ	ዚ	ዛ	ዜ	ዝ	ዞ
ze 1st	*zu* 2nd	*zi* 3rd	*za* 4th	*zé* 5th	*z(i)* 6th	*zo* 7th

ዝ *zi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ዝናብ.



ዘ IS FOR

ዝናብ

zi-nab

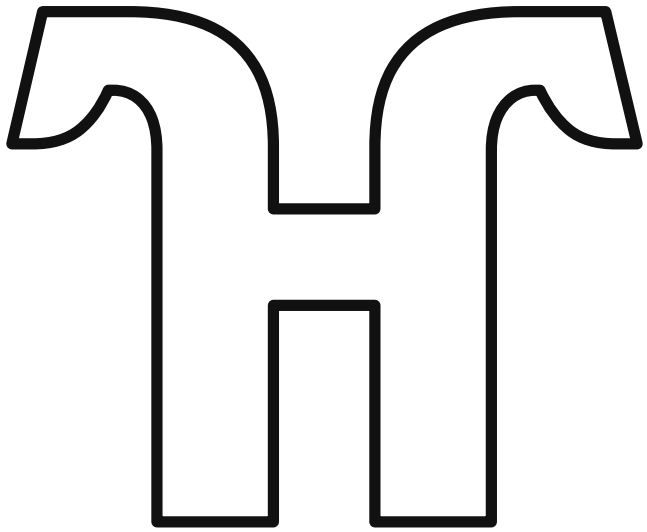
rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ዘ ዘ ዘ ዘ

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NAME · ስም

ዠ

zhe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

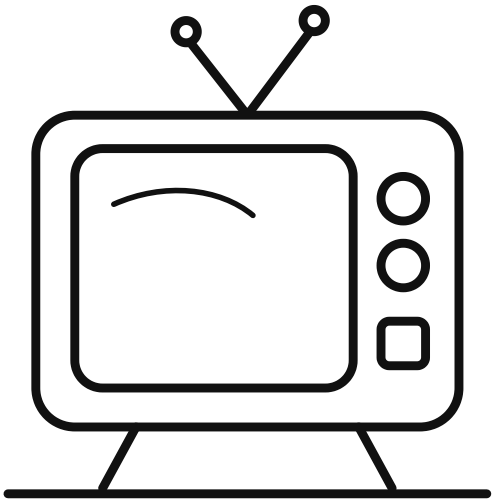
‘zh’ like the ‘s’ in “measure” — a rare letter

THE ዠ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ዠ	ዡ	ዢ	ዣ	ዤ	ዥ	ዦ
zhe 1st	*zhu* 2nd	*zhi* 3rd	*zha* 4th	*zhé* 5th	*zh(i)* 6th	*zho* 7th

ዥ *zhi*, the **6th** sound of this family, is found inside the word ቴሌቪዥን.

ዠ is found only in borrowed words. Find ዥ in ቴሌቪዥን!



ዠ IS FOR

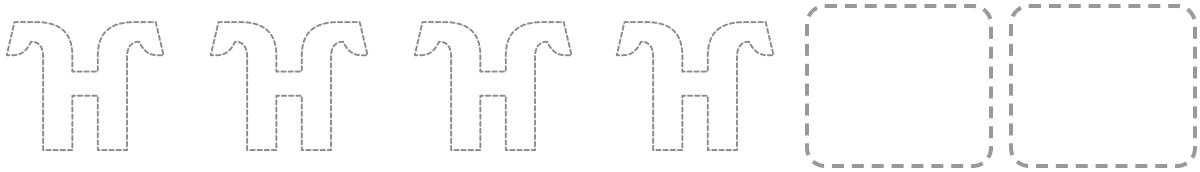
ቴሌቪዥን

té-lé-vi-zhin

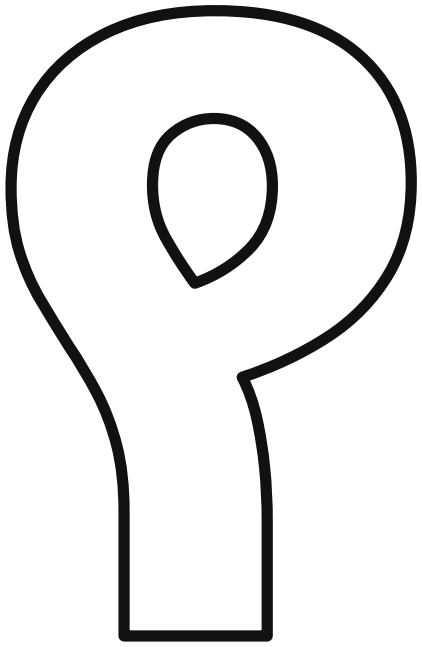
television

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ



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NAME · ስም

የ

ye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

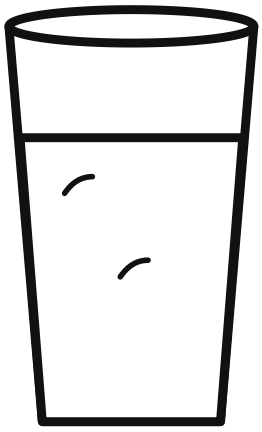
‘y’ as in “yes”

THE የ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

የ	ዩ	ዪ	ያ	ዬ	ይ	ዮ
ye 1st	*yu* 2nd	*yi* 3rd	*ya* 4th	*yé* 5th	*y(i)* 6th	*yo* 7th

ይ *yi*, the **6th** sound of this family, is found inside the word ማይ.

Few Tigrinya words start with የ. Find ይ at the end of ማይ!



የ IS FOR

ማይ

may

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

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ደ

NAME · ስም

ደ

de

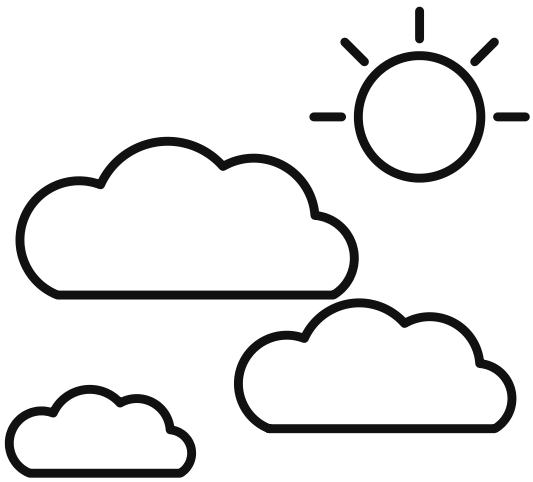
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘d’ as in “door”

THE ደ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ደ	ዱ	ዲ	ዳ	ዴ	ድ	ዶ
de 1st	*du* 2nd	*di* 3rd	*da* 4th	*dé* 5th	*d(i)* 6th	*do* 7th

ደ *de*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ደበና.



ደ IS FOR

ደበና

de-be-na

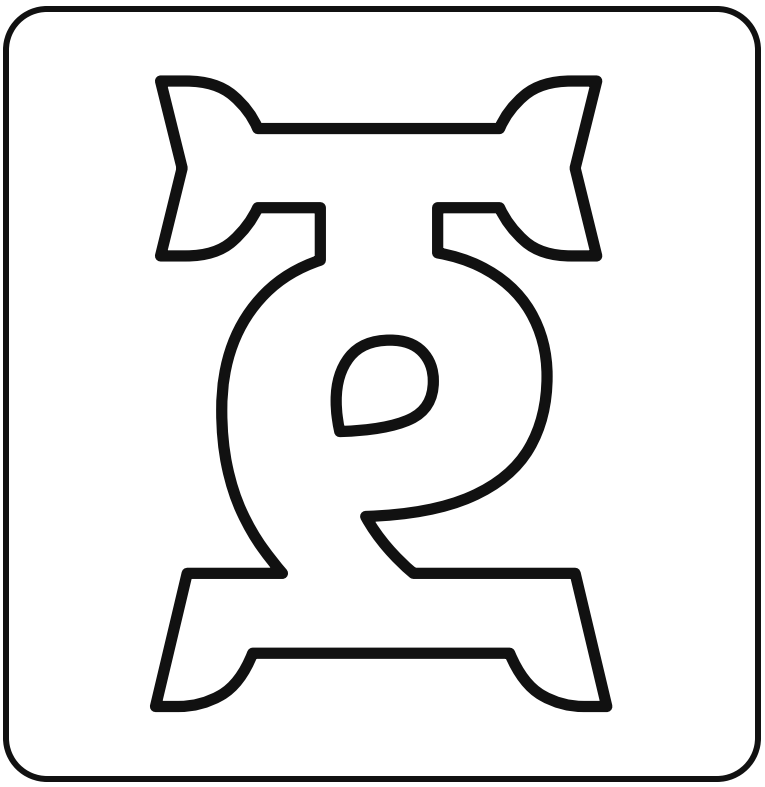
cloud

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ደ ደ ደ ደ

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NAME · ስም

ጀ

je

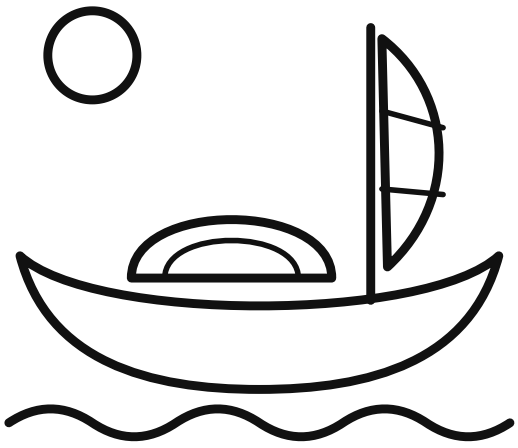
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

THE ጀ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ጀ	ጁ	ጂ	ጃ	ጄ	ጅ	ጆ
je 1st	*ju* 2nd	*ji* 3rd	*ja* 4th	*jé* 5th	*j(i)* 6th	*jo* 7th

ጀ *je*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ጀልባ.



ጀ IS FOR

ጀልባ

jel-ba

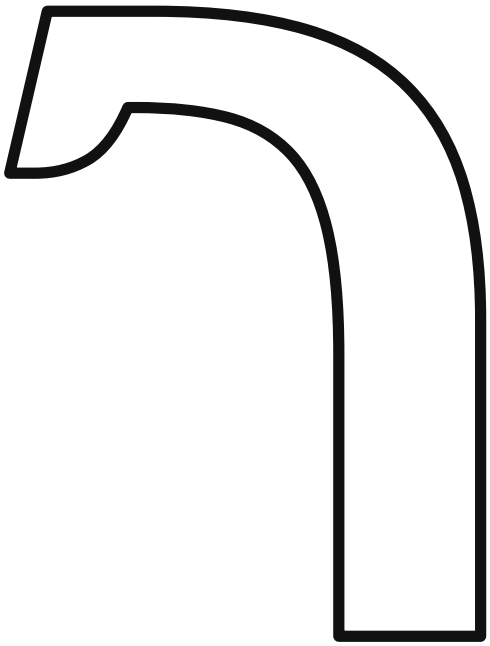
boat

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ጀ ጀ ጀ ጀ

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NAME · ስም

ገ

ge

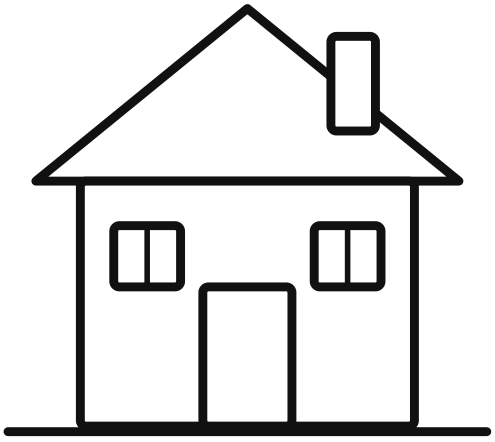
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

THE ገ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ገ	ጉ	ጊ	ጋ	ጌ	ግ	ጎ
ge 1st	*gu* 2nd	*gi* 3rd	*ga* 4th	*gé* 5th	*g(i)* 6th	*go* 7th

ገ *ge*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ገዛ.



ገ IS FOR

ገዛ

ge-za

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ገ ገ ገ ገ

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ጠ

NAME · ስም

ጠ

t'e

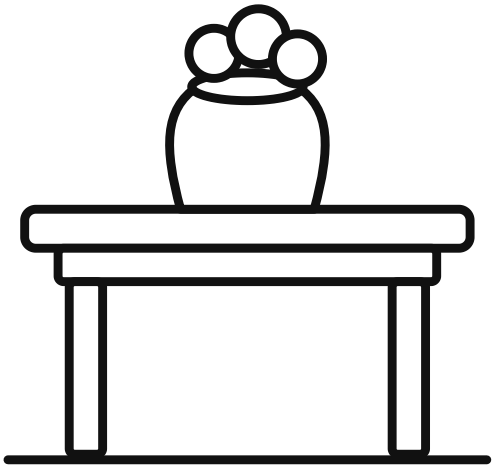
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a popped ‘t’ (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ጠ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ጠ	ጡ	ጢ	ጣ	ጤ	ጥ	ጦ
t'e 1st	*t'u* 2nd	*t'i* 3rd	*t'a* 4th	*t'é* 5th	*t'(i)* 6th	*t'o* 7th

ጣ *t'a*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ጣውላ.



ጠ IS FOR

ጣውላ

t'aw-la

table

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ጠ ጠ ጠ ጠ

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ጨ D ጨ D ጨ D

NAME · ስም

ጨ

ch'e

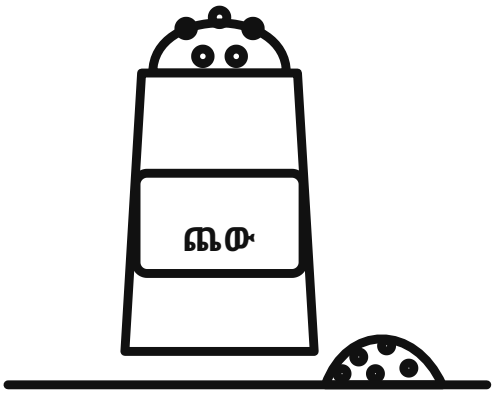
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a popped ‘ch’ (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ጨ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ጨ	ጩ	ጪ	ጫ	ጬ	ጭ	ጮ
ch'e 1st	*ch'u* 2nd	*ch'i* 3rd	*ch'a* 4th	*ch'é* 5th	*ch'(i)* 6th	*ch'o* 7th

ጨ *ch'e*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ጨው.



ጨ IS FOR

ጨው

ch'ew

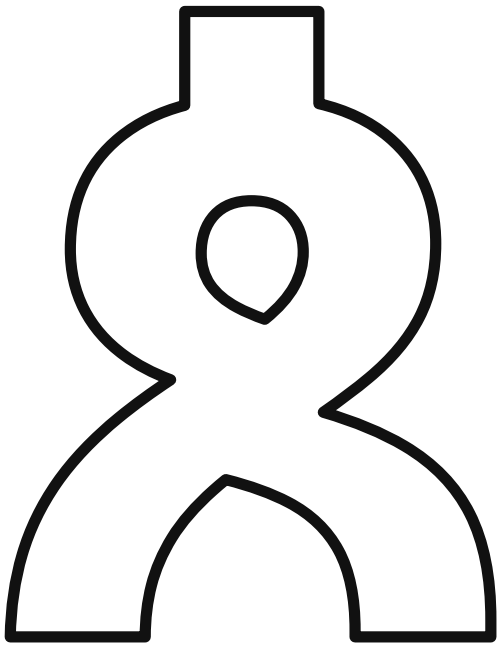
salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

ጨ ጨ ጨ ጨ

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NAME · ስም

ጰ

p'e

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

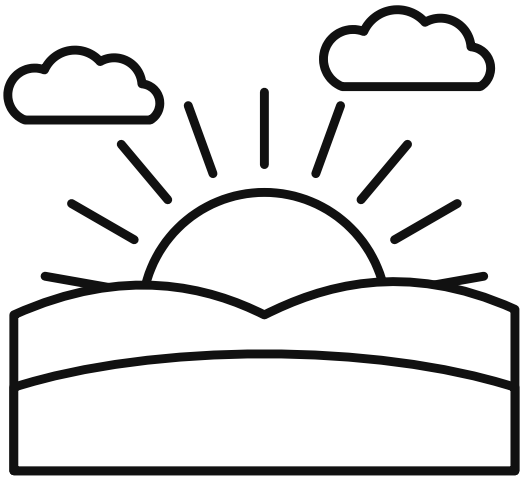
a popped ‘p’ — a rare letter (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ጰ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ጰ	ጱ	ጲ	ጳ	ጴ	ጵ	ጶ
p'e 1st	*p'u* 2nd	*p'i* 3rd	*p'a* 4th	*p'é* 5th	*p'(i)* 6th	*p'o* 7th

ጳ *p'a*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ጳጉሜን.

The Ge’ez calendar has 13 months: twelve of 30 days, then ጳጉሜን with 5 or 6 days.



ጳ IS FOR

ጳጉሜን

p'a-gu-mén

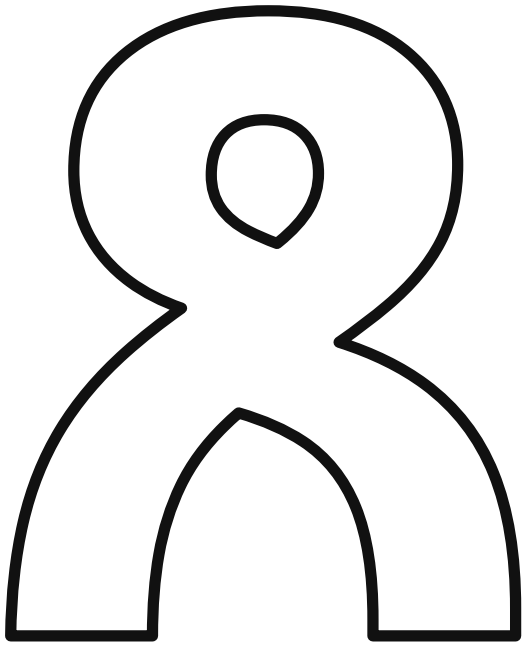
Pagumén, the short 13th month

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሑፍ

ጰ ጰ ጰ ጰ

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NAME · ስም

ጸ

ts'e

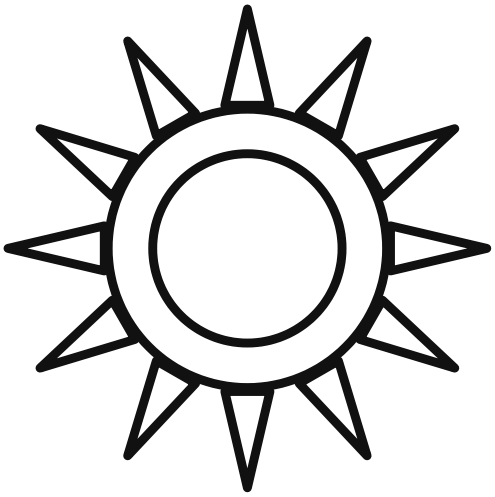
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a popped ‘ts’ (a popped sound: hold your breath, then let the sound burst out)

THE ጸ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ጸ	ጹ	ጺ	ጻ	ጼ	ጽ	ጸ
ts'e 1st	*ts'u* 2nd	*ts'i* 3rd	*ts'a* 4th	*ts'é* 5th	*ts'(i)* 6th	*ts'o* 7th

ጸ *ts'e*, the **1st** sound of this family, starts the word ጸሓይ.



ጸ IS FOR

ጸሓይ

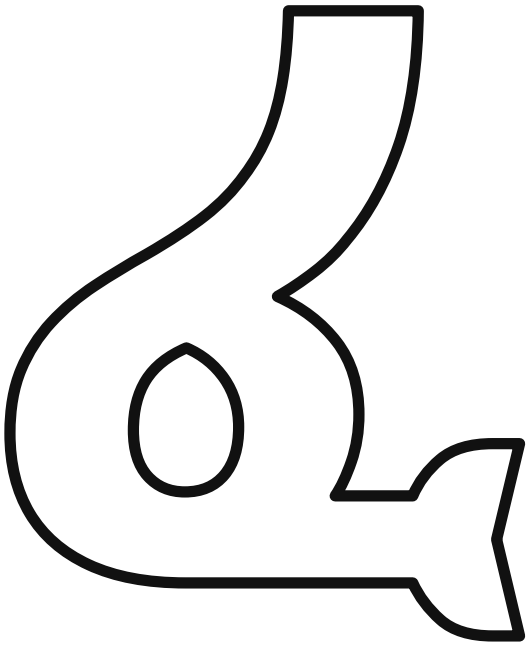
ts'e-ḥay

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

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NAME · ስም

ፈ

fe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

THE ፈ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ፈ	ፉ	ፊ	ፋ	ፌ	ፍ	ፎ
fe 1st	*fu* 2nd	*fi* 3rd	*fa* 4th	*fé* 5th	*f(i)* 6th	*fo* 7th

ፍ *fi*, the **6th** sound of this family, starts the word ፍሩታ.



ፈ IS FOR

ፍሩታ

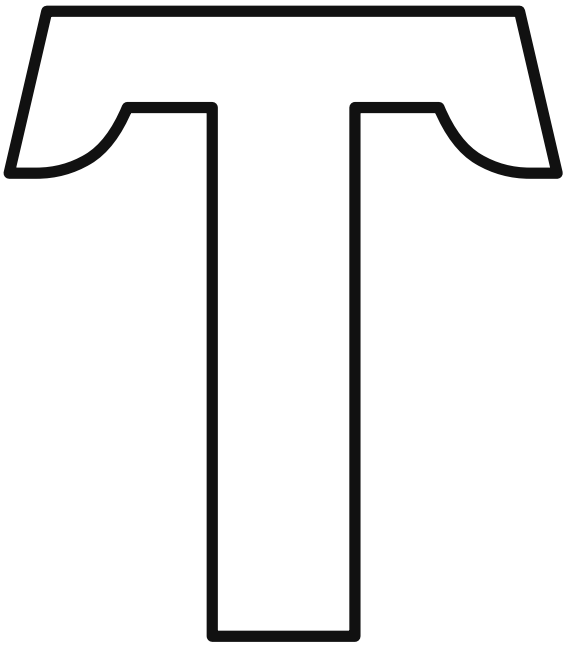
fi-ru-ta

fruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

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NAME · ስም

ፐ

pe

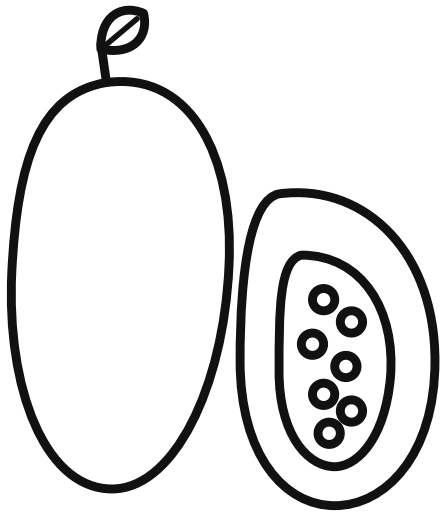
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘p’ as in “pen”

THE ፐ FAMILY · 7 SOUNDS

ፐ	ፑ	ፒ	ፓ	ፔ	ፕ	ፖ
pe 1st	*pu* 2nd	*pi* 3rd	*pa* 4th	*pé* 5th	*p(i)* 6th	*po* 7th

ፓ *pa*, the **4th** sound of this family, starts the word ፓፓያ.



ፐ IS FOR

ፓፓያ

pa-pa-ya

papaya

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ጽሓፍ

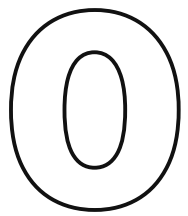
ፐ ፐ ፐ ፐ

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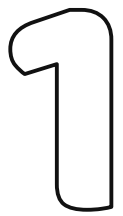
BONUS

Tigrinya numbers ቁጽርታት *(qu-ts'ir-tat)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Tigrinya: *zé-ro*, *ḥa-de*, *kil-te*, *se-les-te*...



0
ዜሮ
zé-ro
zero



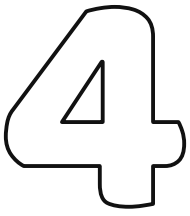
1
ሓደ
ḥa-de
one · ፩



2
ክልተ
kil-te
two · ፪



3
ሰለስተ
se-les-te
three · ፫



4
ኣርባዕተ
ar-ba-ʿi-te
four · ፬



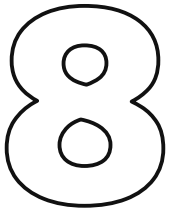
5
ሓሙሽተ
ḥa-mush-te
five · ፭



6
ሽዱሽተ
shi-dush-te
six · ፮



7
ሸውዓተ
shew-ʿa-te
seven · ፯



8
ሸሞንተ
she-mon-te
eight · ፰



9
ትሽዓተ
tish-ʿa-te
nine · ፱

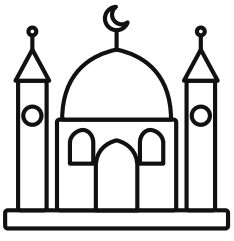
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LET'S TALK

My first Tigrinya words ቀዳሞት ቃላት

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

ኣሰላሙ ዓለይኩም	*as-se-la-mu ʿa-ley-kum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
ወዓለይኩም ኣሰላም	*we-ʿa-ley-kum as-se-lam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
ሰላም!	*se-lam!* **Hello!**
ስመይ ... እዩ	*sim-ey ... i-yu* **My name is ...**
የቐንየለይ	*ye-qhen-ye-ley* **Thank you**
ጀዛከላሁ ኸይራን	*je-za-ke-la-hu khey-ran* **May Allah reward you with good**
ኣደ · ኣቦ	*a-de · a-bo* **Mother · Father**
ሓው · ሓብቲ	*ḥaw · ḥab-ti* **Brother · Sister**
እወ · ኣይፋል	*i-we · ay-fal* **Yes · No**
ትግርኛ ይመሃር ኣለኹ!	*tig-ri-nya yi-me-har a-le-khu!* **I am learning Tigrinya!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

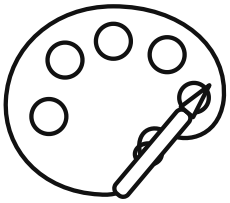
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **32 Tigrinya letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Tigrinya, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ማሻኣላህ! ኣዝዩ ጽቡቕ!

ma-sha-al-lah! az-yu ts'i-buqh! — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 32 letters of the Tigrinya alphabet.

_____ _____

Date Grown-up's signature

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

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